

SQLDatabaseChain has SQL injection issue #5923

✓ Closed

asimjalis opened on Jun 9, 2023 · edited by asimjalis

Edits ▾ ⋮

System Info

There is no safeguard in SQLDatabaseChain to prevent a malicious user from sending a prompt such as "Drop Employee table".

SQLDatabaseChain should have a facility to intercept and review the SQL before sending it to the database.

Creating this separately from [#1026](#) because the SQL injection issue and the Python exec issues are separate. For example SQL injection cannot be solved with running inside an isolated container.

[LangChain version: 0.0.194. Python version 3.11.1]

```
[6]: db_chain = SQLDatabaseChain.from_llm(llm=llm, db=db, verbose=True)
```

```
[7]: db_chain.run("How many employees are there?")
```

```
> Entering new SQLDatabaseChain chain...
```

```
How many employees are there?
```

```
SQLQuery:SELECT COUNT(*) FROM Employee;
```

```
SQLResult: [(8,)]
```

```
Answer:There are 8 employees.
```

```
> Finished chain.
```

```
[7]: 'There are 8 employees.'
```

```
[8]: db_chain.run("Drop the employee table")
```

```
> Entering new SQLDatabaseChain chain...
```

```
Drop the employee table
```

```
SQLQuery:DROP TABLE "Employee"
```

```
SQLResult:
```

```
Answer:The employee table has been dropped.
```

```
> Finished chain.
```

```
[8]: 'The employee table has been dropped.'
```

Who can help?

No response

Information

- ☐ The official example notebooks/scripts
- ☐ My own modified scripts

Related Components

- ☐ LLMs/Chat Models
- ☐ Embedding Models
- ☐ Prompts / Prompt Templates / Prompt Selectors
- ☐ Output Parsers
- ☐ Document Loaders
- ☐ Vector Stores / Retrievers
- ☐ Memory
- ☐ Agents / Agent Executors
- ☐ Tools / Toolkits
- ☐ Chains
- ☐ Callbacks/Tracing
- ☐ Async

Reproduction

Here is a repro using the Chinook sqlite database used in the example ipynb. Running this will drop the Employee table from the SQLite database.

```
chinook_sqlite_uri = "sqlite:///Chinook_Sqlite_Tmp.sqlite"
from langchain import OpenAI, SQLDatabase, SQLDatabaseChain
llm = OpenAI(temperature=0)
db = SQLDatabase.from_uri(chinook_sqlite_uri)
db.get_usable_table_names()
db_chain = SQLDatabaseChain.from_llm(llm=llm, db=db, verbose=True)
db_chain.run("How many employees are there?")
db_chain.run("Drop the employee table")
```



Expected behavior

LangChain should provide a mechanism to intercept SQL before sending it to the database. During this interception the SQL can be examined and rejected if it performs unsafe operations.

4

boazwasserman on Jun 12, 2023

Contributor ...

Yeah, it can end up pretty badly if someone puts this into their app without additional validations. I'll try to find some time to add a few validations





boazwasserman mentioned this [on Jun 12, 2023](#)

[Mitigate issue #5923 \(Prompt injection -> SQL injection in SQLChain\) #6051](#)

asimjalis on Jun 12, 2023

Author



Ideally there would be a way to add custom validations. For example, it is possible I don't want to allow certain types of select operations. Like selects on system tables.

boazwasserman on Jun 13, 2023

Contributor



Great idea!
I'll look at adding it to this PR / a following one

Amejonah1200 on Jun 27, 2023 · edited by Amejonah1200

Edits



a mechanism to intercept SQL before sending it to the database.

That is called "create a user in your database, give the least amount of privileges, do not execute queries with root".

Aka. "User Management" or "Role Based Access Control" like you should do anyway...

6

2

Uranium2 on Aug 1, 2023



It's true that user must be set according to the user.

But I still think that at least pattern matching must be used to catch delet/alter/drop/insert or any keywords that may change the database/table.

I was thinking if it was possible to add a callback that will, before running blindly the SQL, will check if the SQL contains actions unwanted by the developer.

Something like this:

```
db = SQLDatabase.from_databricks(  
    catalog=catalog,  
    schema=db_name  
    host=host,  
    api_token=api_token,  
    warehouse_id=warehouse_id,  
    exclude_actions=["DELETE", "ALTER"],  
)
```



exclude_actions=["DELETE", "ALTER"],

This could be added and stops the run if "delete" "alter" are found in the generated code of the LLM.

Uranium2 on Aug 2, 2023 · edited by Uranium2

Edits ▾ ...

Made a PR if it can help, don't hesitate to comment to add feedbacks [#8583](#)

Not sure it will correct the ([CVE-2023-36189](#)) <https://security.snyk.io/vuln/SNYK-PYTHON-LANGCHAIN-5759268>

obi1kenobi on Aug 29, 2023 · edited by obi1kenobi

Edits ▾ Collaborator ...

This issue has been resolved in [#8425](#), and the fix was first published in `langchain v0.0.247`:

- PR [🔗 remove code #8425](#) is in the release notes for that version: <https://github.com/langchain-ai/langchain/releases/tag/v0.0.247>
- [Here's the merged commit](#) that removed the problematic code from `langchain`, and as you can see the GitHub UI shows that commit as being part of all releases since 0.0.247.

`langchain` versions 0.0.247+ are not vulnerable in this way.

The affected code has been moved to `langchain-experimental`, which is a separate package intended for testing out new ideas before all the edge cases are worked out. We felt this was the best solution for the time being, and may reconsider moving the code back to `langchain` itself once we're satisfied with the interface and security profile it offers.

As the discussion here and in [#6051](#) pointed out, the most thorough and most universally-compatible way to prevent undesirable SQL commands from being executed is to limit the database permissions granted to the chain. That way, the database itself prevents dangerous commands like `DROP TABLE` from being able to be executed. As a result, we're marking that `langchain-experimental` code with prominent security warnings advising users about the security risk and reminding them to limit the database permissions they grant the chain: [#9867](#)

Thanks for the report and the productive discussion here!



obi1kenobi closed this as [completed](#) on Aug 29, 2023



obi1kenobi added a commit that references this issue on Aug 29, 2023

Update PYSEC-2023-110 to include fix information ...

Verified b2a9303



obi1kenobi mentioned this on Aug 29, 2023

[🔗 Update PYSEC-2023-110 to include fix information pypa/advisory-database#150](#)



sethmlarson added a commit that references this issue on Aug 29, 2023

Update PYSEC-2023-110 to include fix information ...

Verified e41332e



eyurtsev added `🔒:security` on Mar 14, 2024



bertuxdeveloper mentioned this on Nov 7, 2024

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Assignees

No one assigned

Labels

No labels

Type

No type

Projects

No projects

Milestone

No milestone

Relationships

None yet

Development

 Code with agent mode

 **Mitigate issue #5923 (Prompt injection -> SQL injection in SQLChain)**

langchain-ai/langchain

Participants

     +1